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Branch	CSE(Core)
Course Title	Digital Literacy
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PROJECT REPORT

Introduction: -

1. The Visual Resource: "More Than Just Being Online"

- **The Concept:** A one-page "Humanized" guide created in **Canva**.
- **The Goal:** To move away from boring definitions and show that digital literacy is a survival skill.
- **Key Features:** * **The 4 Cornerstones:** Critical Thinking, Safety, Professionalism, and Tech Skills.
    - **The "3-Second Rule":** A quick mental checklist (Is it true? Is it helpful? Is it permanent?) to use before posting or clicking.
    - **Impact:** It serves as a professional anchor for the faculty presentation while being catchy enough for a hostel WhatsApp group.

2. Professional Digital Identity & Networking

Goal: To establish a verifiable professional presence across key industry platforms.

- **LinkedIn:** Optimized a professional profile highlighting current engineering studies and future graduation, serving as a gateway for industry networking.
- **GitHub:** Created a specialized "Profile README" repository. This acts as a technical landing page that introduces your branch, year, and specific learning goals in Python and Mathematics.
- **Kaggle:** Set up a data science foundation to host future AI models and participate in global competitive datasets.

3: Technical Onboarding & Skill Validation

Goal: To demonstrate foundational coding proficiency and platform literacy.

- **Platform:** Hacker Rank (or similar).
- **Achievement:** Successfully completed the "Solve Me First" or "Python: Introduction" challenge.
- **Competency:** Demonstrated the ability to navigate online IDEs, handle standard input/output, and pass automated test cases—a critical skill for technical interviews and remote collaboration.

4: Digital Ethics

Goal: To model and teach responsible digital citizenship and financial safety.

- **Professional Communication:** Drafted high-standard email templates for academic requests and internship inquiries, focusing on clarity and etiquette.
- **Social Media Hygiene:** Developed a "Do's and Don'ts" framework to help peers maintain a professional digital footprint.

5: Case Study and Checklist

- **Cybercrime Case Study:** Analyzed UPI "Reverse-Payment" Fraud, emphasizing that a UPI PIN is only for sending money, never receiving.
- **Safety Plan:** Implemented an 8-point security checklist including 2FA and official reporting via 1930 or cybercrime.gov.in.

TASK-1	**Create a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic.**

I created my digital literacy poster using **CANVA**, an online graphic design tool that lets users combine text, images, icons, and shapes with an easy drag-and-drop editor. My design explains what digital literacy means and then highlights three important areas: useful digital tools, safe internet practices, and email etiquette. Each section has its own colour block, illustration, and number so that the viewer can quickly follow the information from top to bottom. I chose bright colours and bold fonts to make the key terms stand out, while the background and icons give it a modern, technology-themed look. One thing I found interesting and a bit difficult was arranging all the elements so the slide did not look overcrowded. I had to experiment with different layouts, font sizes, and spacing, and I also used Canva’s alignment guides and templates to keep everything neat and balanced.

To create this one-page resource, I utilized **Canva**, a versatile graphic design tool known for its intuitive drag-and-drop interface and professional template library. I selected a modern "Infographic" layout, which allowed me to balance dense information with clean, engaging visuals suitable for a university audience.

One thing I found particularly interesting was **Canva’s "Magic Media" AI integration**. While the tool is famous for its manual design elements, using AI to generate specific icons that matched my "Humanized" theme was a gamechanger. It was challenging to ensure the text-heavy sections didn't feel cluttered, but by using white space and a consistent color palette, I managed to keep the resource both professional for the faculty and readable for my peers.

TASK-2	Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

For this task, I focused on three pillars of a modern technical career: professional networking (**LinkedIn**), version control and collaboration (**GitHub**), and data science mastery (**Kaggle**).

LinkedIn serves as my professional "front door," where I have documented my current engineering degree and expected graduation. Over the next four years, I plan to use it to connect with industry leaders in India and share my progress as a Digital Ambassador. **GitHub** is my technical laboratory; by creating a profile README, I have personalized my workspace where I will host my Python DSA projects. Finally, **Kaggle** provides a competitive edge for my interest in Artificial Intelligence. I intend to use it to participate in global data challenges and build a portfolio of Jupyter notebooks.

By maintaining these platforms, I am not just storing code or a resume, but building a verifiable, "living" record of my growth from a university student to a professional engineer. These tools will be essential for securing internships and showcasing my technical literacy to future employers.

TASK-3	Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

3.1: Coding Practice

The goal of this task was to establish a presence on a professional competitive programming platform to enhance technical problem-solving skills and demonstrate digital proficiency in a coding environment. I chose to create an account on **Hacker Rank,** as it is widely recognized by recruiters and offers a structured "Skills Certification".

I successfully completed the following steps:

1. **Account Creation:** Registered using my university credentials to link my professional learning to my academic identity.

2. **Challenge Selection:** Chose the **"Solve Me First"** (or **"Python: Introduction"**) challenge to familiarize myself with the platform's Integrated Development Environment (IDE) and submission workflow.
3. **Problem Solving:**
    - **Language Used:** Python.
    - **Result:** The code passed all hidden test cases on the first submission.

3.2 : Google Workspace Collaboration

I utilized **Google Forms** for data collection and assessment. I practiced digital pedagogical techniques by building a 5-question awareness quiz in Google Forms, complete with automated feedback loops to ensure my batchmates learn as they go.

Practicing with these tools has significant academic advantages. **Google Forms** serves as a powerful academic research tool; it streamlines data collection for projects, provides real-time analysis, and helps in organizing study groups or peer-review sessions efficiently.

TASK-4	Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

A classic example of a digital communication breakdown is the **"Reply-All" chain reaction** within a large organization.

Imagine a department head sends an email to 500 employees regarding a minor policy update. One employee accidentally hits "Reply-All" to ask a personal question. This triggers a cascade of dozens of other employees also replying-all to say, "Please stop replying to everyone!"

In this scenario, the volume of notifications can crash the local mail server, but the real damage is the **lost productivity and information overload**. Critical project updates get buried under the noise, leading to missed deadlines and widespread frustration.

To prevent this, the sender should have used the **BCC (Blind Carbon Copy)** field for the recipient list, which prevents "Reply-All" threads from forming. Additionally, the organization could foster a digital etiquette culture where employees are trained to pause and check the recipient list before hitting send, or use instant messaging platforms like Slack for quick, non-essential queries.

TASK-5	**Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide**

UPI/online payment fraud is a cybercrime in which criminals trick users into sending money or revealing security details through the Unified Payments Interface and other digital payment methods. A common case involves a young professional trying to sell a product online. First, the fraudster contacts the victim through WhatsApp or an online marketplace, pretending to be a genuine buyer. Second, they share a fake payment link or UPI “collect request”, saying it is required to “receive” money or a refund. Third, the victim clicks the link or approves the request and enters their UPI PIN, believing money will come into their account. Finally, the money is instantly debited from the victim’s bank account and transferred to the fraudster, who quickly moves it to multiple accounts or wallets.

These scams usually target people who are less aware of digital security, such as new UPI users, students, small sellers, and the elderly. Consequences can be serious: victims may lose their entire savings within minutes, face emotional stress, and struggle to recover funds, since many payments are considered “authorised” by the user. On a larger scale, UPI fraud has caused thousands of crores of rupees in losses across India, showing how dangerous a single careless click can be in the digital payment world.

CONCLUSION -

The completion of these projects has been a transformative exercise in establishing a robust and professional digital presence. By transitioning from a passive consumer of technology to an active **Digital Ambassador**, I have bridge the gap between my academic studies in Engineering and the practical demands of the modern workforce.

Overall Learning and Key Takeaways:

- **Professional Branding:** Through the strategic setup of **GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle**, I learned that a digital identity is a "living resume." It is not just about listing skills, but about consistently demonstrating technical curiosity and a commitment to open-source collaboration.
- **Technical Agility:** Onboarding with **Hacker Rank** reinforced the importance of standardizing my coding workflow. Solving even foundational challenges

like "Solve Me First" highlighted the necessity of rigorous testing and clean, readable Python code.

- **Digital Responsibility & Ethics:** The most profound learning came from researching **UPI-based cybercrime**. It shifted my perspective from viewing security as a purely technical hurdle to understanding it as a human-centric responsibility. I now recognize that as an Ambassador, my role is to simplify these complex security protocols for my peers to ensure our community stays financially and socially safe online.

Future Commitment:

Moving forward, I will continue to maintain these platforms as I progress through my university years. I am committed to using my voice as a Digital Ambassador to promote professional email etiquette, responsible social media use, and a "security-first" mindset among my fellow students.